



- **Brackets** are used within a quotation with the italicized Latin word *sic*, which is used to show that words within a **quotation** have been **reproduced exactly** as they were written. For example, “I heard that the farmer, Mr. Cwpat [*sic*], is alive.”
- If using a keyboard that doesn’t have a dash, typing **two hyphens** (--) is an acceptable substitute. **Never** use a dash in place of a hyphen, though.

A dash is **longer than a hyphen**. On old-fashioned **typewriters**, **two hyphens** typed one after the other were used instead of a **dash**.

Dashes for interruptions

Dashes perform the same function as parentheses, surrounding additional information in a sentence. While parentheses must always be used in pairs, only one dash is required if the interruption comes at the beginning or end of a sentence.

—by all accounts—

The sentence would still make sense without the part within the dashes, so this part could be removed.

It was a long wait—the longest I’d ever had.

No spaces should be left between the dash and the surrounding words.

This part of the sentence gives additional information about how long the wait was.

was—by all accounts—“laden 5–6 hours, it finally arrived.

Dashes for ranges

A dash can be used to express ranges of numbers, as in the case of dates or page references. In these situations, only the first and last numbers are written. Technically, ranges require the use of a shorter dash called an “en dash,” as opposed to the longer “em dash.” A dash also expresses ranges of months or days of the week, and it can be used to indicate the direction of travel.

5–6 hours

This means “5 to 6 hours.” If the word *from* is written before the number, use *to*, not a dash.

Monday–Friday

This includes Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday.

the Trys–Qysto route

This means that the route goes from Trys to Qysto.